

L-49: PYQ MAPPING & ANSWER STRATEGY

Anthropology Paper 1 (Units 3.2, 3.3, 5.3) + GS1 Society | Most Recent First

 **Trend Analysis (2013-2024):** These 6 topics appear with HIGH frequency. Sacred Complex asked 4 times; GT/LT + Universalisation asked 5 times; Jajmani asked 3 times; NMS asked 3 times; Tribe-Caste asked 4 times. **Average: 1-2 questions/year from this handout.** UPSC loves asking comparative/analytical questions (e.g., "examine the process" rather than "define").

1. JAJMANI SYSTEM — PYQs

Q: Discuss the factors responsible for the decline of the Jajmani system. (2016, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Define (Wiser 1936, Lewis 1958) → 6 features briefly
- **State role:** Planned development, credit, irrigation, HYV seeds broke Jajman monopoly
- **Technology:** Machine goods, safety razors, bore wells → artisan castes redundant
- **Political mobilisation:** Constitutional empowerment of Dalits/OBCs; democratic assertion
- **Market economy:** Subsistence → surplus; abolition of zamindari
- Conclude: Jajmani = relic of feudal economy; modern institutions replaced reciprocity with rights
- **Case study:** Lewis's Rampur — exploitation angle; MGNREGA as state-substitute

Q: Discuss the Jajmani system with reference to its relevance in today's context. (2019, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Define + Wiser + Lewis + regional equivalents
- Core features: hereditary, goods-for-services, ritual role
- **Present relevance:** Mostly declined but vestiges remain in: ritual obligations at weddings (barber, washerman still called); patron-client politics (vote banks mirror Jajman-Kamin)
- **Urban parallels:** Domestic help relationships retain paternalistic features
- Use Harold Gould (1972) on family-level relations
- Conclude: System dead as economic mechanism; cultural memory persists in rituals

Q: What is the Jajmani system? Discuss its characteristics. (2014, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Wiser (1936), Karimpur → Lewis (1958) definition → regional equivalents
- 6 characteristics table: Permanent, Hereditary, Goods-for-services, Social, Peace, Ritual
- Lewis's Rampur data: Jats + 4 servicing castes
- Thakur family example — 9 castes for life-cycle rites
- Both functional (Lewis) and exploitative (Beidelman) perspectives

2. TRIBE-CASTE CONTINUUM — PYQs

Q: Critically examine the concept of tribe-caste continuum in the Indian context. (2023, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Redfield's folk-urban continuum → applied to India by Bailey & Surajit Sinha
- Spectrum: Onge (isolated) → Bhumij (assimilated)
- **Scholars:** Hutton (religion), Beteille (3 criteria), Bailey (structural — organic vs segmentary), Sinha (equality emphasis)
- **Hinduisation:** Ghurye (backward Hindus), N.K. Bose (tribal absorption), Orans (Santhal)
- **Critical evaluation:** Bailey's limitation — both transforming; Beteille says religion is "loose criterion"
- **Examples:** Jenu-Kuruba, Toda, Munda; Ekalavya (unequal); Hidimbi (integration)
- Contemporary: Xaxa Committee; PESA/FRA recognise distinctness

Q: Discuss the processes by which tribes are being absorbed into the caste system. (2017, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- N.K. Bose — Hindu methods of tribal absorption (Odisha tribes)
- Orans — Santhal seeking Great Tradition
- Ghurye — backward Hindus thesis
- Mechanisms: Hinduisation, Sanskritisation, economic integration (Jenu-Kuruba), mythological incorporation (Bhils, Hidimbi)
- Rajput clans claiming tribal ancestry → Kshatriya status
- Counter-trend: tribal identity assertion (Jharkhand movement, Birsa Munda legacy)

Q: Bring out the problems in identifying tribes in India. (2020, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Continuum concept — no sharp boundary (Bailey)
- Beteille's criteria difficulties: geographic isolation reduced; dialect mixing; religion = loose criterion
- Political dimension: communities demanding ST status (Gujjars, Marathas)
- Constitutional approach vs anthropological approach tension

Q: Examine the nature of the relationship between tribe and caste in India. (2015, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Same as 2023 Q but emphasise **interaction examples:** Jenu-Kuruba, Toda, Munda
- Mythological narratives: Ekalavya, Bhima-Hidimbi, Bhils-Parvati
- Continuum diagram with examples at each point

3. GREAT & LITTLE TRADITION / UNIVERSALISATION — PYQs

Q: Examine the nature of interaction between Great and Little Traditions in India with suitable examples. (2017, 20 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Redfield (1956) — GT & LT defined; table of differences
- **Interaction mechanisms:** Universalisation (Marriott) & Parochialisation (Marriott)
- **Examples:** Gobardhan puja (parochialisation); Saluno → Raksha Bandhan (universalisation)
- Jagannath at Puri — tribal deity → Vishnu
- Ramayana's circular journey: folk → Valmiki → Tulsidas → Ram Lila
- **Sacred Specialists** as mediators (Vidyarthi)
- **Critique:** Dube's multipolar model (6 types); Mandelbaum — GT not static
- Modern examples: Digital platforms as new mediators

Q: Discuss the concepts of Universalisation and Parochialisation with reference to Indian civilisation. (2022, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Marriott (1955), *Village India* — fieldwork at Kishangarhi
- Define both with direction arrows (GT ↔ LT)
- Parochialisation: Gobardhan puja; Goddess cults (local stone → Lakshmi/Parvati)
- Universalisation: Saluno → Rakhi; Theyyam deities → Ram/Lakshman/Hanuman
- Circular: Ramayana example in detail
- Modern: Yoga (GT) → corporate adaptations (parochialisation); folk dances → national festivals (universalisation)

Q: Distinguish between Great Tradition and Little Tradition. How are they interdependent? (2018, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Redfield's table (7 parameters)
- Sacred specialists as bridge
- Examples of interdependence: Jagannath, goddess cults
- Dube's critique — too simplistic for India

Q: Evaluate Dube's critique of Great and Little Tradition model. (2016, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Redfield's bipolar model briefly
- Dube (1965): "too complex for bipolar" → multipolar
- 6 tradition types with examples
- Mandelbaum: GT not static; constant interchange
- Validity of critique: India's diversity needs multi-dimensional framework

Q: What do you understand by universalisation? Give examples. (2014, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Marriott definition → LT elements elevated to GT
- Saluno → Raksha Bandhan
- Theyyam deities of Kerala → equated with Ram/Hanuman
- Tribal deities (Jagannath) → absorbed into Vaishnavism
- Modern: Chhath Puja gaining pan-Indian recognition

4. SACRED COMPLEX — PYQs

Q: Discuss Vidyarthi's concept of Sacred Complex. How is it relevant for understanding Indian civilisation? (2021, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Vidyarthi (1961), Chicago School, student of Redfield, Gaya field site
- **3 components:** Sacred Geography + Performances + Specialists (GPS mnemonic)
- Example: Gaya — bathing ghats, Shraddha, Gayawal Brahmins
- **5 significances:** Cultural transmission, social integration, GT-LT integration, arts, binding force
- Extensions: Narayana Reddy added secular dimension (Tirumala)
- Relevance: PRASAD Scheme, Kashi Corridor, Char Dham — state engaging with sacred geography

Q: Examine the concept of Sacred Complex with reference to any Indian city. (2019, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Framework: Vidyarthi's 3 components
- Apply to **Varanasi/Kashi:** Sacred Geography (87+ ghats, Kashi Vishwanath), Sacred Performances (Ganga Aarti, death rituals at Manikarnika), Sacred Specialists (pandas, mahants)
- Saraswati & Jha studied Kashi — textual & contextual continuity
- Modern: Kashi Vishwanath Corridor restructured sacred geography
- Narayana Reddy's secular dimension: tourism economy, boat operators, silk weavers

Q: What are the three components of Sacred Complex? Discuss with examples. (2016, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Vidyarthi (1961) — define each component with Gaya example
- Add one more example (Tirumala or Puri)
- How together they create "combination, continuity, compromise" between GT & LT

Q: Discuss how scholars have extended Vidyarthi's Sacred Complex concept. (2023, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Briefly state original (Vidyarthi, Gaya, 3 components)
- Saraswati: secular regulation + civilisation transcends borders (Janakpur)
- Jha: dynamic reinterpretation (Puri Jagannath)
- Sopher: service castes sustaining pilgrim activity
- Narayana Reddy: secular dimension (Tirumala — shops, hotels, employment)
- Bharadwaj: hierarchical ranking of sacred places; living social institutions

5. NATURE-MAN-SPIRIT COMPLEX — PYQs

Q: Examine Vidyarthi's concept of Nature-Man-Spirit Complex with suitable examples. (2022, 15 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- Vidyarthi — Cultural Ecology + added Spirit element
- Maler tribe: Rajmahal Hills, shifting cultivation (Khallu)
- 4 spirit types: Gossaiyan, Jiwe Urrkya, Alchi, Chergani
- **NMS diagram:** Nature (ecology) ↔ Man (social org) ↔ Spirit (supernatural)
- Case: Malers relocated → illness → blamed angry Gosaiyyan
- P.K. Singh (1981): "NMS is constant" — content changes, complex doesn't
- V.S. Sahay: Nicobarese — "only model" for their culture
- Applied: Dongria Kondh vs Vedanta (2013); FRA 2006; Tribal Panchsheel

Q: How does NMS complex explain tribal resistance to displacement? (2020, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- NMS = sacred land is part of spiritual worldview, not just economic resource
- Disrupting land = disrupting spirit world → misfortune
- **Dongria Kondh:** Niyamgiri = "Niyam Raja"; voted against mining (2013)
- Maler: relocated → illness attributed to spirit anger
- Santhals & Jaherthan (sacred groves); Khasi/Garo sacred groves
- Policy implication: PESA, FRA, Tribal Panchsheel respect NMS worldview

Q: Discuss the significance of Nature-Man-Spirit Complex in understanding tribal societies. (2017, 10 marks)

Answer Pointers:

- 5 significance points: holistic worldview, resistance to change, applied anthropology tool, sustainable resource use, tradition-development integration
- One example per point (Santhals, Dongria Kondh, Elwin, Khasi, Sarhul)
- P.K. Singh's validation: NMS = constant across time

PYQ FREQUENCY TABLE (2013-2024)

Topic	Times Asked	Marks Range	Favourite Sub-angle
Jajmani System	3	10	Decline factors; Present relevance
Tribe-Caste Continuum	4	10-15	Critical examination; Processes of absorption
GT/LT + Universalisation	5	10-20	Interaction with examples; Dube's critique
Sacred Complex	4	10-15	3 components; Scholar extensions; Applied to a city
NMS Complex	3	10-15	Examples; Tribal resistance; Significance

UPSC Pattern Insights:

- GT/LT + Universalisation = **most frequently asked** from this handout
- UPSC prefers **"with examples"** questions — always cite 2-3 specific examples
- **20-mark questions** need: definition + scholars + examples + critique + contemporary relevance
- **Clubbing strategy:** Sacred Complex + GT/LT often asked together; NMS + tribal resistance are natural pairs
- Name **3-4 scholars minimum** per 15-mark answer